Connect an AI assistant in Positron

International Marketing Analytics

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Three assistants, three ways in

Assistant	Where in Positron	Account	Cost
GitHub Copilot	Posit Assistant chat and suggestions	GitHub account with Copilot	free for students
Claude Code	the terminal	Claude Pro, Max, Team, Enterprise or Console	paid plan
Codex	the terminal	ChatGPT account or OpenAI API key	best with Plus or higher

Course default: GitHub Copilot. Claude Code and Codex are optional; nobody has to pay for anything.

GitHub Copilot



Part 1 of 3 · connect it to Posit Assistant

Connect GitHub Copilot

1. **Copilot on GitHub:** github.com/settings/copilot shows Copilot Free, Student or Pro
2. **Command Palette:** Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P, run Authentication: Configure Language Model Providers
3. **GitHub Copilot:** choose it and sign in in the browser, with the same GitHub account
4. **Restart:** quit Positron completely (macOS: Cmd + Q) and start it again
5. **Test:** View: Show Posit Assistant, pick a model (Auto), type: Say hello

Not enough: signing in through the Accounts menu. Use Configure Language Model Providers.

No model in the picker?

1. **“Configure a language model provider” although connected:** quit Positron completely, start again
2. **Still empty:** github.com/settings/copilot, turn on Copilot Free or Student for this account
3. **Wrong account:** Configure Language Model Providers, sign out of Copilot, sign in again
4. **Restricted Mode in the status bar:** click it and trust the folder
5. **Diagnose:** AI: Create Diagnostic Report; 0 models means the GitHub account

Works? run a cell first, then ask about your data: Posit Assistant sees your Python session.

Claude Code

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Part 2 of 3 · the agent in Positron's terminal

Install Claude Code in the terminal

Windows: Positron terminal (PowerShell)

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

macOS: Positron terminal

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

New terminal: check, then start

```
claude --version
claude
```

Sign in

- Pro, Max or Console account
- Code shown? Paste it

Billed to the API by mistake? if ANTHROPIC_API_KEY is set, Claude Code may use it instead of Pro. Type /status to check.

Claude in the Positron terminal: checklist

1. **Account:** Claude Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise, or a Console account; free claude.ai plan: no Claude Code
2. **Install once:** the installer of the last slide; no admin rights, no WSL; Git for Windows is optional
3. **Check:** new terminal tab, claude --version and claude doctor; not recognized? quit Positron fully, restart
4. **Start and sign in:** claude in the project folder, sign in in the browser; /status shows the account; /exit ends
5. **Optional, diffs in the editor:** also install the Claude Code extension, then type /ide (test it once)

Optional: needs a paid Claude plan. Course default: Posit Assistant with GitHub Copilot, free for students.

Codex

Part 3 of 3 · OpenAI's agent in Positron's terminal

Install Codex in the terminal

Windows: Positron terminal (PowerShell)

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy ByPass -c "irm https://chatgpt.com/codex/install.ps1 | iex"
```

macOS: Positron terminal

```
curl -fsSL https://chatgpt.com/codex/install.sh | sh
```

New terminal: start, check

```
codex
codex login status
```

Sign in



- Choose Sign in with ChatGPT
- Browser fails? codex login --device-auth



Works without the extension: the terminal route is the most reliable way in Positron.

Codex in the Positron terminal: checklist

1. **Account:** ChatGPT Plus, Pro, Business, Edu or Enterprise; Free and Go with tighter limits; or an API key
2. **Install once:** the installer of the last slide, or brew install --cask codex; Windows: no WSL needed
3. **Check:** new terminal tab, codex login status; not recognized? quit Positron fully and restart
4. **Start and sign in:** codex in the project folder, Sign in with ChatGPT; browser fails? codex login --device-auth
5. **Optional, live session:** tick ai.mcp.enabled, Positron MCP: Add to Coding Agent → Codex, start codex here

Optional: best with ChatGPT Plus or higher. Course default: Posit Assistant with GitHub Copilot, free for students.

Use them safely

1. **Ask first:** read every proposed change and command before you approve it; never /yolo
2. **Check:** run the code yourself and compare every number; you own every number
3. **No personal data:** no names, e-mails or IDs in prompts or in a session an agent can see
4. **Training off:** in the Claude or ChatGPT privacy settings, and on github.com/settings/copilot
5. **Course rule:** AI is allowed; keep a prompt log in your exercises

In short: the assistant proposes, you decide and check.

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